



TIPS & TRICKS



Record audio from your microphone via the command line

First, download the 'sox' tool suite which is extremely versatile for audio file manipulation. Use the following command on Debian systems:

```
# apt-get install sox libsox-fmt-all
'libsox-fmt-all' package enables playback of mp3 files.
```

The 'sox' suite includes two tools called 'rec' and 'play'.

To record audio, insert a microphone into your audio jack and type the following command:

```
# rec -c 1 test_file.mp3
```

The recording session begins and whatever you speak through the microphone is recorded. Once you are done recording, press **Ctrl+C**.

To play the recorded file, type the following:

```
#play test_file.mp3
```

'sox' can also handle audio files of formats like wav, ogg, etc.

—*Divya Lakshmanan,*

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Download videos using the YouTube downloader in Linux

First, install *youtube-dl* by following the steps given below.

If you are running an Ubuntu based Linux distribution, you can install it using the following:

```
sudo apt-get install youtube-dl
```

For any other Linux distro, you can quickly install *youtube-dl* on your system through the command line interface with the following command:

```
sudo wget https://yt-dl.org/downloads/latest/youtube-dl -O/usr/
local/bin/youtube-dl
```

After fetching the file, you need to set an executable permission on the script for it to execute properly.

```
sudo chmod a+rx /usr/local/bin/youtube-dl
```

To download a video file, simply run the following command, where 'VIDEO_URL' is the URL of the video that you want to download.

```
youtube-dl <VIDEO_URL>
```

You can also download in multiple formats. Run the commands below to discover all that can be done using this tool:

```
youtube-dl -h
```

...or:

```
man youtube-dl
```

—*Mounica Revuru,* ojaswithamounica@gmail.com



Tips for day-to-day use

Given below are a few handy tips for those who use Linux daily.

Resume typing a command after a few others

Sometimes, after typing a long and complex command on a Linux terminal, we realise that we have to type some other commands, and even examine their results, before we hit **Enter**. Instead of discarding what we have typed, or opening another terminal/GUI text editor to store it, we can just go to the end of our typed line by using **Ctrl E**, and press **Ctrl U** to clear the line. Then, we can execute the intermediate command and just press **Ctrl Y**. Voila! The deferred command reappears for us to modify or execute with the use of **Enter**. Think of it as a kind of cut-and-paste for the contents of the line preceding the cursor.

Docker emergency shutdown

As of release 1.12.1, Docker does not have a single command to stop all running containers. But here